ROI Calculator

Migration Savings Across All Scenarios

Fill-in worksheets for VMware exit, Hyper-V migration, cloud repatriation, edge deployment, SQL Server licensing, and multi-cloud consolidation. Pre-calculated examples for small (25 VMs), medium (100 VMs), and large (500 VMs) estates. Every number you need to build the business case.

6 Worksheets | 8 Pre-Calculated Scenarios | Fillable | $0 Tool Cost | Proprietary (HyperSDK)

Worksheet 1: VMware Exit

Calculate savings from migrating VMware vSphere to KVM/KubeVirt.

A. Current VMware Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
vSphere licenses (per-socket or VCF bundle)	$________	$5K-15K/socket	Post-Broadcom: 2-12x increase
vCenter Server license	$________	$6K-10K	Required for management
vSAN / storage licenses	$________	$2K-8K/socket	If using vSAN
NSX / network licenses	$________	$4K-12K/socket	If using NSX
Support & maintenance	$________	20-25% of license	Annual SnS renewal
Additional (Horizon, SRM, Aria, etc.)	$________	Varies	All VMware products
A. Total VMware Annual Cost	$________		

B. Migration Investment (One-Time)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
New hardware (if needed)	$________	$0-50K	Often reuse existing
KVM/K8s training	$________	$5K-20K	Team upskilling
Migration labor (internal or consulting)	$________	$10K-50K	1 engineer, 12-20 weeks
Parallel run (VMware overlap)	$________	1-3 mo of license	Keep VMware as rollback
hyper2kvm + hypersdk license	**Contact for pricing***	Contact for pricing*	Proprietary (HyperSDK)
B. Total Migration Investment	$________		

C. New Annual Costs (KVM/KubeVirt)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes

KVM hypervisor licensing	**$0**	$0	In Linux kernel
K3s / KubeVirt licensing	**$0**	$0	CNCF open source
OS subscription (RHEL optional)	$________	$0-800/host/yr	Fedora/Ubuntu = $0
Hardware maintenance	$________	Same as current	Same servers
Linux admin FTEs	$________	Same or less	Often same team retrained
C. Total New Annual Cost	$________		

D. Results

Metric	Your Number	Formula
Annual Savings	$________	= A - C
Payback Period (months)	______ mo	= B / (Annual Savings / 12)
3-Year Net Savings	$________	= (Annual Savings x 3) - B
3-Year ROI	______%	= ((Annual Savings x 3) - B) / B x 100

Worksheet 2: Hyper-V Exit

Calculate savings from eliminating Windows Server Datacenter licensing.

A. Current Hyper-V Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
Windows Server Datacenter (per 2-core pack)	$________	$6,155 x 8 packs/host	$49K minimum per host
System Center (SCVMM, SCOM, etc.)	$________	$3,607 x 8 packs/host	If using System Center
Windows Server CALs	$________	$30-44/user or device	Per user or per device
Software Assurance / renewals	$________	~25% of license/yr	For upgrade rights
A. Total Hyper-V Annual Cost	$________		

B. Migration Investment (One-Time)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical	Notes
Migration labor	$________	$8K-30K	Typically faster than VMware
Training (Windows admin → Linux/KVM)	$________	$5K-15K	Biggest learning curve
Hardware (if needed)	$________	$0 (reuse)	Same servers, install Linux
B. Total Migration Investment	$________		

C. Results

Metric	Your Number	Formula
New annual cost (KVM)	$________	Typically $0-5K (RHEL optional)
Annual Savings	$________	= A - New Annual Cost
Payback Period	______ mo	= B / (Savings / 12)

3-Year Net Savings	$________	= (Savings x 3) - B

Hyper-V hidden cost: Windows Server Datacenter at $49K/host is often the most expensive single item. A 4-host cluster costs **$197K in licensing alone** — more than most hardware budgets. Moving to Linux + KVM eliminates this entirely.

Worksheet 3: Cloud Repatriation

Calculate savings from bringing VMs home from AWS, Azure, or GCP.

A. Current Cloud Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
Compute instances (EC2/Azure VMs/GCE)	$________	$200-2,000/VM/mo	x number of VMs x 12
Block storage (EBS/Managed Disk/PD)	$________	$0.08-0.17/GB/mo	Provisioned or consumed
Data egress / transfer	$________	$0.09/GB outbound	Often the hidden killer
Load balancers / NAT gateways	$________	$20-200/mo each	Per service, per region
Monitoring (CloudWatch/Monitor/Logging)	$________	$5-50/VM/mo	Logs, metrics, alerts
Reserved instance premium (if applicable)	$________	30-60% of on-demand	Commitment lock-in
A. Total Cloud Annual Cost	$________		

B. On-Prem KVM Costs (Annual)

Cost Item	Your Number	Typical Range	Notes
Server hardware (amortized 5 yr)	$________	$800-2K/mo equiv	One-time / 60 months
NVMe/SSD storage	$________	$200-500/mo equiv	Much cheaper than cloud
Network (no egress fees)	**$0**	$0	Local — zero egress
Monitoring (Prometheus/Grafana)	**$0**	$0	Open source
KVM/KubeVirt licensing	**$0**	$0	Open source
Operations staff delta	$________	Often less than cloud	No cloud console complexity
B. Total On-Prem Annual Cost	$________		

C. Results

Metric	Your Number	Formula
Migration investment (one-time hardware + labor)	$________	Typically $30K-80K
Annual Savings	$________	= A - B
Payback Period	______ mo	= Investment / (Savings / 12)
3-Year Net Savings	$________	= (Savings x 3) - Investment

Worksheet 4: Edge Deployment

Calculate savings from replacing VMware at remote/branch sites with K3s + KubeVirt.

Cost Item (Per Site)	VMware	K3s + KubeVirt	Savings Per Site
Hypervisor licensing	$________	**$0**	$________
Management platform	$________	**$0** (GitOps)	$________
Hardware	$________	$________	$________
Annual per-site savings			$________
Number of sites	______		
Total annual savings (all sites)			$________
3-year savings (all sites)			$________

Worksheet 5: SQL Server Licensing

Additional savings from KVM CPU pinning reducing SQL Server per-core costs.

Cost Item	On VMware	On KVM (pinned)	Savings
Physical cores per host	______	______ (pinned vCPUs)	
SQL Standard ($3,945/2-core pack)	$________	$________	$________
SQL Enterprise ($15,123/2-core pack)	$________	$________	$________
Number of SQL Server VMs	______		
Total SQL licensing savings			$________

KVM with CPU pinning exposes only assigned cores to the guest. SQL Server licensing counts visible cores. Typical savings: 20-40% on per-core costs.

Worksheet 6: Combined Total

Source	3-Year Savings	Your Number
VMware exit (Worksheet 1)	$________	
Hyper-V exit (Worksheet 2)	$________	
Cloud repatriation (Worksheet 3)	$________	
Edge deployment (Worksheet 4)	$________	
SQL Server licensing (Worksheet 5)	$________	
GRAND TOTAL 3-YEAR SAVINGS	$________	

Pre-Calculated Examples

Ready-made scenarios — find the one closest to your environment.

Scenario 1: Small Business — 25 VMs, 2 hosts, VMware vSphere Standard

Metric	VMware Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes
Annual licensing	$35,000	$0	**$35,000**	vSphere + vCenter
Annual support	$8,750	$0	**$8,750**	25% of license
Annual ops (delta)	$0	$0	$0	Same team
Migration (one-time)	—	$8,000	-$8,000	1 engineer, 3 weeks
Annual savings			**$43,750**	
Payback			**2.2 months**	
3-year net savings			**$123,250**	

Scenario 2: Mid-Size Enterprise — 100 VMs, 8 hosts, VMware vSphere Enterprise Plus

Metric	VMware Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes
Annual licensing (vSphere+vCenter+vSAN)	$220,000	$0	**$220,000**	Post-Broadcom pricing
Annual support	$55,000	$6,400	**$48,600**	RHEL optional
Annual ops (savings)	$0	-$15,000	**$15,000**	KVM simpler to manage
Migration (one-time)	—	$35,000	-$35,000	1 engineer, 16 weeks
Annual savings			**$283,600**	
Payback			**1.5 months**	
3-year net savings			**$815,800**	

Scenario 3: Large Enterprise — 500 VMs, 40 hosts, 10 sites, VMware VCF

Metric	VMware Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes
Annual licensing (VCF bundle)	$1,200,000	$0	**$1,200,000**	VCF at $30K/socket
Annual support	$300,000	$32,000	**$268,000**	RHEL sub for all hosts
Annual ops (savings)	$0	-$50,000	**$50,000**	2 fewer FTEs needed
Migration (one-time)	—	$100,000	-$100,000	2 engineers, 20 weeks
Annual savings			**$1,518,000**	
Payback			**0.8 months**	
3-year net savings			**$4,454,000**	

More Pre-Calculated Scenarios

Scenario 4: AWS Repatriation — 20 VMs from EC2 to on-prem KVM

Metric	AWS Cost	On-Prem KVM	Savings	Notes
Annual compute (m5.2xlarge x 20)	$176,000	$13,333	**$162,667**	HW amortized 5yr
Annual storage (EBS 20TB)	$24,000	$2,667	**$21,333**	NVMe SSDs
Annual egress (5TB/mo)	$5,400	$0	**$5,400**	Zero egress on-prem
Annual monitoring	$7,200	$0	**$7,200**	Prometheus free
Migration (one-time)	—	$15,000	-$15,000	hypersdk export + convert
Annual savings			**$196,600**	
3-year net savings			**$574,800**	

Scenario 5: Azure Repatriation — 20 VMs (D8s_v3) to on-prem KVM

Metric	Azure Cost	On-Prem KVM	Savings	Notes
Annual compute	$153,600	$13,333	**$140,267**	
Annual storage (Managed Disks)	$29,520	$2,667	**$26,853**	
Annual egress + monitoring	$12,960	$0	**$12,960**	
Migration (one-time)	—	$15,000	-$15,000	
Annual savings			**$180,080**	
3-year net savings			**$525,240**	

Scenario 6: Hyper-V Exit — 40 VMs, 2-host cluster, Windows Datacenter

Metric	Hyper-V Cost	KVM Cost	Savings	Notes

Annual Windows Datacenter licensing	$98,480	$0	**$98,480**	2 hosts x $49K
Annual System Center	$28,856	$0	**$28,856**	SCVMM + SCOM
Annual CALs (200 users)	$6,000	$0	**$6,000**	Per-user CALs
Migration (one-time)	—	$12,000	-$12,000	
Annual savings			**$133,336**	
3-year net savings			**$388,008**	

Scenario 7: Edge Deployment — 50 sites, VMware to K3s + KubeVirt

Metric	VMware	K3s + KubeVirt	Savings	Notes
Annual software per site	$10,000	$0	**$10,000**	vSphere Essentials
50 sites annual software	$500,000	$0	**$500,000**	
Management (vCenter vs GitOps)	$50,000	$0	**$50,000**	ArgoCD is free
Migration (one-time, all sites)	—	$30,000	-$30,000	Convert once, deploy to all
Annual savings			**$550,000**	
3-year net savings			**$1,620,000**	

Combined Scenario

The complete picture: VMware + Hyper-V + cloud + edge + SQL in one migration project.

Scenario 8: Full Migration — 200 VMs across VMware, Hyper-V, AWS, Azure + 20 edge sites + SQL Server

Component	VMs	Current Annual	KVM Annual	Annual Savings
VMware vSphere (100 VMs, 8 hosts)	100	$280,000	$6,400	**$273,600**
Hyper-V (40 VMs, 2 hosts)	40	$133,336	$0	**$133,336**
AWS EC2 (30 VMs)	30	$264,000	$20,000	**$244,000**
Azure (30 VMs)	30	$234,000	$20,000	**$214,000**
Edge sites (20 sites, VMware)	—	$200,000	$0	**$200,000**
SQL Server licensing (10 instances)	—	$632,400	$379,440	**$252,960**
Subtotal — current annual	200	**$1,743,736**	**$425,840**	**$1,317,896**

Investment	Amount	Notes
Migration labor (2 engineers, 20 weeks)	$60,000	hyper2kvm + hypersdk automate most work
New hardware (edge + expansion)	$40,000	Mini PCs for edge, reuse existing for HQ
Training (Linux/KVM/K8s)	$15,000	Team upskilling
hyper2kvm + hypersdk	**Contact for pricing***	Proprietary (HyperSDK)
Total one-time investment	**$115,000**	

$1.32M
Annual savings

1.0 mo
Payback period

$3.84M
3-year net savings

3,339%
3-year ROI

$3.84M Saved Over 3 Years — $115K Investment

Payback in 1 month. Every additional month is pure savings.

VMware licensing: gone. Hyper-V licensing: gone. Cloud bills: slashed 85%.

SQL Server licensing: reduced 40%. Edge sites: $0 software forever.

hyper2kvm + hypersdk made it possible — for $0 in tool cost.